

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

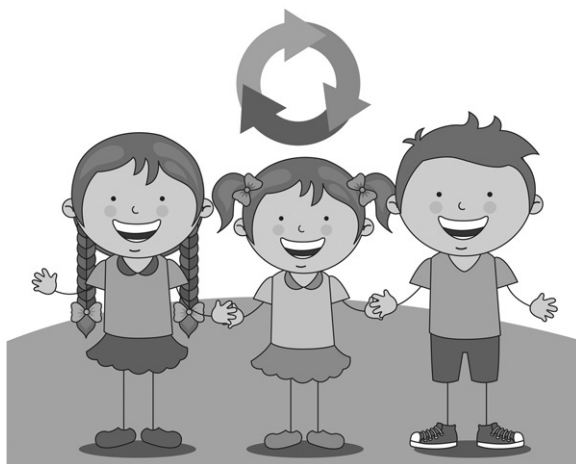
CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

You're doing *what* with old pens?



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in written and spoken situations and in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can describe environmental problems.
- I can talk about things that happened.
- I can talk about things that are happening and things that have happened.

Ask your partner:

- What kinds of items do you think people could repurpose in a better way?
- Have you heard any stories about certain items being repurposed in a creative way?

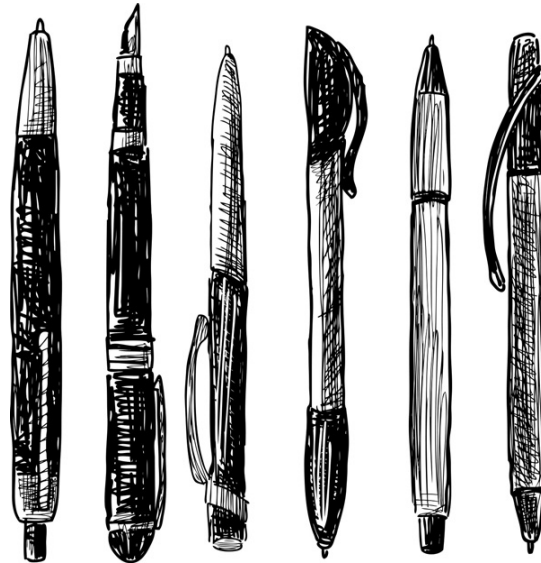




Let's Explore!

Let's read about a girl named Jessica who had **an idea hit her***. What was it?

* When you have "an idea hit you", you suddenly have a new thought or idea.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Several years ago, Jessica Bloom, editor of the school newspaper, decided to do something useful with the large number of pens that were being thrown out every day. Our environment is being affected by junked plastic items, like pens. Instead of discarding her old pens, Jessica began collecting her pens, along with those of other students in her class. Within a short time, Jessica amassed a pen collection that filled up her drawers at home. At first, Jessica was unsure what to do with these discarded items, but then one day when one of her books fell off her shelf, an idea hit her. She took her collection to the local plastic factory and asked them to melt down her pens.

With her soft plastic, Jessica started to design plastic bookends of all different shapes and sizes. Her classmates loved the idea of a creative way to hold their books on a desk or shelf, and started buying the bookends.

Recently, her idea has been taken over by a private design company. They have begun using the plastic from recycled pens in many of their products. The plastic is being repurposed and the company is helping to save the environment.

The recycled plastic is economical and environmentally-friendly. For Jessica and her classmates, this idea has become a method to write their way to a better environment.





Let's Practice!

Can you describe some current environmental problems?

Instructions: Match the sentences on the right with their missing part on the left. Practice saying the sentence(s) aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. Junked plastic items, like pens, | a. are affecting our environment. |
| 2. She took her collection to the local plastic factory | b. is repurposing the plastic to help save the environment. |
| 3. A private design company | c. has taken over her idea recently. |
| 4. The company | d. and asked them to melt down her pens. |
| 5. The recycled plastic | e. is economical and environmentally-friendly. |

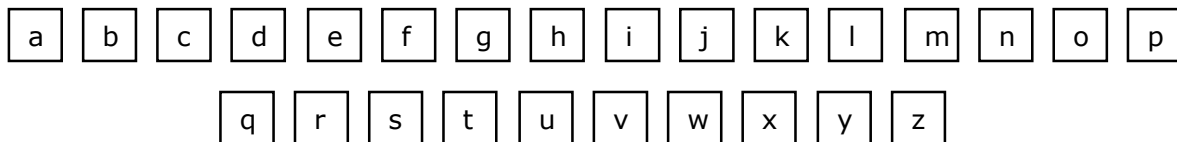


Let's Practice!

What did Jessica do?

Instructions: Select letters to guess the sentence. To replace the first sentence. Practice saying the sentence aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

(Hint: What did Jessica amass and where?)





Extension Activity

Repurpose some items!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Look around you and choose one item to repurpose.
- Write down the ways you want to repurpose that item and why.
- If you need to, draw a diagram or plan.
- Share your idea with a partner.
- Whose idea is best? Why? Discuss.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I think of an object to repurpose.

☐ ☐

I write down/draw out my plan for repurposing an object.

☐ ☐

I share my ideas and discuss other ideas.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to melt down** (verb): to heat a metal or plastic object until it turns to liquid
e.g. She took her collection to the local plastic factory and asked them to melt down her pens.
- **bookend** (noun): one of a pair of objects that you put at the end of a row of books to prevent them from falling over
e.g. She started to design plastic bookends of all different sizes and shapes.
- **to take over** (verb): to gain control of a company or situation
e.g. Her idea has been taken over by a private design company.
- **economical** (adjective): using money, time or goods carefully, without wasting it
e.g. The bookends were economical and children loved them.
- **to repurpose** (verb): to use something in a new way that is different from its original use
e.g. The plastic is being repurposed and the company is helping to save the environment.
- **junked** (adjective): of little or no value
e.g. Our environment is being affected by junked plastic items, like pens.





Learning Points

The Simple Past Tense

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

Usually, when you use the Simple Past tense, the time of the finished action is clear from the context or explicitly mentioned in the sentence.

For example:

*Within a short time, Jessica **amassed** a pen collection that filled up her drawers at home.*

Here is another example:

*One day when one of her books fell off the shelf, an idea **hit** her.*

Remember that there are both regular and irregular verbs. Look at the chart for examples of the Simple Past tense verbs.

Regular Verb		Irregular Verb	
Present	Past	Present	Past
decide	decided	begin	began
amass	amassed	hit	hit

Examples:

- *Several years ago, Jessica Bloom, editor of the school newspaper, decided to do something useful with the large number of pens that were being thrown out every day.*
- *Instead of discarding her old pens, Jessica began collecting her pens, along with those of other students in her class.*
- *She took her collection to the local plastic factory and asked them to melt down her pens.*
- *Her classmates loved the idea of a creative way to hold their books on a desk or shelf, and started buying the bookends.*





Learning Points

The Passive: The Present Continuous and Present Perfect Tenses

You use the Present Continuous to talk about an action that is happening at the time of speaking. The action or event is in progress.

*The company **is helping** to save the environment.*

You use the Present Perfect to talk about a finished action or event with present consequences. There is a connection between what happened in the past and the present.

*They **have begun** using the plastic from recycled pens in many of their products.*

You often choose the passive form when you want to talk about an action but are not so interested in saying who or what does/did it. Passives without *agents* (the doers) are common in academic and scientific writing.

Look at the chart below for the structure of the passive voice.

Name	Structure	Example
Present Continuous	<i>am/are/is + being + past participle</i>	<i>Our environment is being affected by junked plastic items.</i>
Present Perfect	<i>have/has + been + past participle</i>	<i>Recently, her idea has been taken over by a private design company.</i>

Examples:

- *Several years ago, Jessica Bloom, editor of the school newspaper, decided to do something useful with the large number of pens that were being thrown out every day.*
- *Our environment is being affected by junked plastic items, like pens. Instead of discarding her old pens, Jessica began collecting her pens, along with those of other students in her class.*
- *They have begun using the plastic from recycled pens in many of their products.*
- *For Jessica and her classmates, this idea has become a method to write their way to a better environment.*

